Cole

Character Task

See learn for videos, Figma did not let me upload them

Cole

Reflection Questions

What is the movement concept? How should it feel to be the character? How would you describe their movement?

The focus of the movement concept that I tried to imitate is a combat-platformer game. Which means precise and combat should feel fairly lethal, granted due to a prototype we can't have combat so I just focused on the movement. Essentially I wanted to minimize the floatiness and make the character's movement feel snappy but also weighted at the same time. This would feel like near instant acceleration, and near instant deceleration.

What are some games that you can reference that give you a good sense of this?

Well Dead Cells was my primary reference, but I also drew on my knowledge of how games such as hollow knight feel, as it's also a combat-platformer.

What do those games to to address Q1? What do they not do well?

Dead Cells uses high gravity and scales the jump velocity of the player accordingly to minimize time in the air, they also use Coyote time and jump buffering to manipulate the perception of the player.

How do your settings achieve this goal.

I focused on 3 areas; The player's jump, air control, and the acceleration. By changing the jump velocity and acceleration I could create a more punchy launch and increase the effect of gravity to make platforming faster.

How did you strike a balance between responsive and jittery?

I did this by ensuring that the ground friction was fairly high whilst also tuning the braking force, my goal was to completely remove the slide feeling that the default unreal character had.

Playtests

Playtest 1

Playtest 1: Aiden
Was the difficulty appropriate?
Yes, the difficulty was at a nominal level.

What would you say was the key skill you learned in this level chunk? (Don't tell them first)
I learnt how to navigate and platform through the level

Were you able to learn the skill effectively? Why or why not?
Yes, the level design was very straight forward and effectively communicated the skills necessary, like jumping.

Did the design give you any specific ideas or feeling? What did it invoke for you?
The level invoked a feeling of ease, but not too much to where the level is too easy.

Any final thoughts or impressions?
Good design.

Playtest 2

Playtest 2: Conor

Was the difficulty appropriate?
The difficulty was sufficient for what we're going for in our game.

What would you say was the key skill you learned in this level chunk? (Don't tell them first)
Platforming skills, mostly jumping.

Were you able to learn the skill effectively? Why or why not?
Yes, the platforms were spaced in such a way that made learning sufficiently challenging.

Did the design give you any specific ideas or feeling? What did it invoke for you?
The first section gave me a very factory esc feeling, like everything was the same. Kind of maddening if I'm being honest, but that's something we could apply to our game maybe.

Any final thoughts or impressions?
I enjoyed the vertical section, I think that's something our game can really benefit from. The sense of moving upwards is a core part of the narrative of our game.

Playtest 3

Playtest 3: Cate
Was the difficulty appropriate?
The difficulty was fine, there were no failure points for the player.

What would you say was the key skill you learned in this level chunk? (Don't tell them first)
Ascending and descending through platforms.

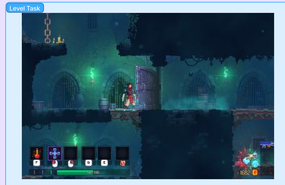
Were you able to learn the skill effectively? Why or why not?
Yes and it was clear on where to go.

Did the design give you any specific ideas or feeling? What did it invoke for you?
It felt like climbing through an office building if it was in dead cells

Any final thoughts or impressions?

The end felt like breaking free

Level Task



Why did you choose this example? What makes it an effective reference for Moontower?

This one is a small puzzle, I think it makes an effective example of what simple puzzles we may want to implement in moontower. The most important part, is that it's a locked door with an obvious pressure pad to open it.

What player skills does this level test? Is it at a beginner, intermediate or advanced level of difficulty?

I would say this is intermediate, as there is a puzzle that involves some combat to progress past. This is just a basic logic puzzle however.

Do the aesthetic elements support the overall level design? Why or why not? (Include specific examples to back up your argument).

Yes the visuals for the area clearly convey the door is special and has some other method of activting.

Why did you choose this example? What makes it an effective reference for Moontower?

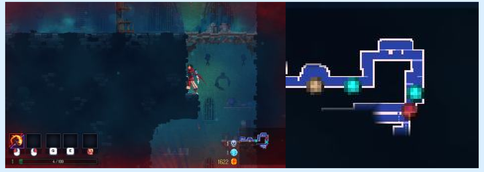
This is a good example of a combat room, I chose this due to the multiple variants of enemies present. Which makes it a great example for the combat rooms we will have in MoonTower.

What player skills does this level test? Is it at a beginner, intermediate or advanced level of difficulty?

Purely dodging and combat, advanced due to the types and amount of enemies.

Do the aesthetic elements support the overall level design? Why or why not? (Include specific examples to back up your argument).

Yes, the contrast of the color on enemies vs the rest of the level distinctly seperates them visually.



Why did you choose this example? What makes it an effective reference for Moontower?

I chose this due to the vertical platforming in this section. This part of the generation I found well suited for the vertical aspect of moontower.

What player skills does this level test? Is it at a beginner, intermediate or advanced level of difficulty?

The skills it tests are the player's ability to move around the map vertically. As it's more of a transition area and there are no enemies or hazards I would say beginner.

Do the aesthetic elements support the overall level design? Why or why not? (Include specific examples to back up your argument).

I think the aesthetics do support the design, due to the lack of bright colors, or enemies you can be assured that there is no immediate threat.

Level Design Reflection

[A2] 3.1: Q1: What was the core experience you wanted for the player?

My intent was for the player to get a feel for the basic mechanics regarding platforming.

[A2] 3.1: Q2: How does the layout support the goal of the level?

I tried to give lots of room for the player to experiment, which led to a fairly open level.

[A2] 3.1: Q3: How did you balance difficulty and fairness?

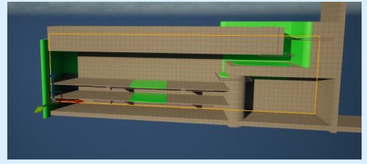
Balance and fairness was pretty easy to deal with as there was not really any imminent threats, so players may keep trying until they get it.

[A2] 3.1: Q4: How did you use risk and reward in your design?

Most of the risk and reward comes from the jumps themselves, as we were unable to create enemies you have to imagine the added pressure of an archer lining up their shot whilst the player is trying to platform away.

[A2] 3.1: Q5: How does the final result compare to your initial vision?

While it wasn't exactly what I would have done if I had the extra room, within the limits of the assignment I am happy with it.



One of the primary goals of my testing was to see how the platforming in our version felt in comparison to dead cells, especially since platforming is such an important part of dead cells. Since that is a huge part of dead cells' combat. Thus I modeled a section of the level that I had encountered a few times in the game play of dead cells I've played.

[A2] 1.3: Q1: What is the main goal or objective of this level segment?

There is a green circle pad on the top after the vertical segment which is used in the default side scroller to signify the end, this is also used in my example.

[A2] 1.3: Q2: How does the level guide the player towards the objective?

The player is funneled toward the final object which is a green pad on the top. The only other paths are dead ends.

[A2] 1.3: Q3: How is the pacing and difficulty changed or introduced?

The pacing is introduced very slowly as there is no real threat.

[A2] 1.3: Q4: Where are the risk and reward elements in the level?

If we had enemies there would be risks and rewards of entering and fighting the enemies in each room, (a door is signified by the vertical block on the roof).

[A2] 1.3: Q5: What are the unique mechanics or features in this level segment?

The level is centered around the platforming aspect of the game, one more interesting segment is the vertical shaft to the exit.